

ChromeOS & Future

A Chromebook is a laptop that runs on the Chrome OS. This is a device specifically designed to be used with an internet connection, and most of the applications and files it needs live in the cloud. This is also based on the Linux kernel, and recently we've heard that Chrome OS might merge with Android into a rumoured OS called Andromeda. Such a move would give Google some serious reach into spaces currently dominated by Apple and Microsoft. In an interview, Hiroshi Lockheimer (Head of Android presently) said that they were working on converging the desktop and smartphone experience to make it one and the same. If the merger does happen, Chrome OS could become the desktop OS with access to the world's biggest user base and App Store. However, Google has been rather silent about Andromeda.

The Piracy Problem

A significant problem that the platform faces is piracy. The open philosophy of Android means that piracy is very easy, unlike on iOS. There's also data to back up the notion that the kind of people who buy into Apple's iOS are fundamentally different from the kinds who want Android (based on research done by Matt Gemmell). Android users want stuff for free, and are clever enough to find ways to get even paid things for free.

Google has tried to combat this by pushing out constant updates that break such pirated apps, and Google also disables application downloads from untrusted sources by default. However, Android's own flexibility is its undoing in this regard, because users can control it better.

When all is said and done, Android is still the most powerful platform out there, and richly deserves the popularity and marketshare it commands. Funny isn't it that what started out as an unknown digital camera firmware, is a household name that is pretty much single-handedly responsible for dragging much of the world into the digital era? And that's why we love technology, and why Google is such a big part of all of our lives! 